

each other, while vigorous trees will become very large and may require as much as 25 ft (8 m).

Dig in well-rotted manure or compost before planting. Trees will need staking for the first three or four years, so ensure that the stake is sturdy before you plant your tree. Attach any horizontal training wires before planting cordons or espaliers.

CROP CARE

Young apple trees need to be kept well watered while their fruits are developing, especially those that are trained into fans and cordons or growing in pots.

Feed trees in early spring with a balanced fertilizer, and consider applying extra nitrogenous fertilizer to culinary apple trees.



Beautiful apple blossom in springtime.

Mulch after feeding with a layer of well-rotted manure or compost. If soil is particularly poor you may want to apply a mulch biannually; if soil is rich, bark chippings may suffice.

Although apples generally blossom later in the season than trees such as pears or cherries, and are therefore less vulnerable

TIP GROW IN CONTAINERS

If grown on a dwarfing or non-vigorous rootstock, apples will thrive in containers and in limited space. Feed with fertilizer in early spring, and ensure that you keep your tree well-watered, since containers will dry out faster than the open ground. Pot up every few years. Growing trees in containers enables you to cover them with netting against pests, or protect against frost with fleece.



Dwarfing apples will happily produce a crop in a confined growing space.